

pdfview

A lightweight PDF reader for Windows

Continuous scrolling, real text selection, two-page spreads, whole-document search, and page previews in Explorer.

[Sample document](#)

Reading

Scrolling is continuous. Pages are drawn as they come into view and released when they leave, so a nine hundred page file costs about what a short one does.

Text stays selectable and copyable, because the page is real text rather than a picture of text. Links work. So does the outline, when a document has one.

Every file reopens on the page you left it on, so picking a long document back up does not mean hunting for your place.

Spreads

Three page layouts: one page at a time, two pages side by side, or two pages with the cover on its own.

The last one matches how a printed book actually falls open. The cover sits alone, then pages two and three face each other, then four and five, and so on.

Page Down moves a whole spread rather than a single page, so paging through a book reads the way it should.

Finding things

Search runs over the whole document, not just the page in front of you. It reports which match you are on and how many there are.

Every match on a page is highlighted, with the one you are looking at picked out in orange so it does not get lost among the others.

In Explorer

PDF files show their own first page as their icon, with a small badge in the corner, instead of a generic document symbol.

The page is drawn by the PDF renderer built into Windows, running inside the isolated host the shell uses for exactly this, so a bad file cannot take Explorer down with it.

Printing

Printing hands the printer the document itself rather than a picture of what is on screen, so the output keeps the original vectors and text.

The printer dialog is the ordinary Windows one. Nothing is stamped across the header and footer.